

Before You File or Call: New Hampshire Family Case Preparation

A first-step organizer for court papers, deadlines, current orders, financial records, and questions for legal help.

Planning aid only. Not legal advice, not legal authority, and not an official court form. Court rules, forms, filing requirements, and agency information can change. Verify every legal or procedural step against a current official New Hampshire source before relying on it.

Start with the signed documents

- Find the complete signed order, parenting plan, Uniform Support Order, child-support worksheet, and any later modifications.
- Record the court location, docket number, date of the order, date you received any new papers, and every stated deadline.
- Do not rely on a text-message summary of an order. Work from the filed or certified copy.

Build a one-page facts sheet

- List each child, the current weekly schedule, school or childcare logistics, transportation responsibilities, and important medical needs.
- List both parents' known income sources without guessing. Separate facts you can document from questions that still need answers.
- Write the exact change you are asking for and how it would work on ordinary school weeks, holidays, vacations, and emergencies.

Documents to gather

- Recent pay records, tax returns, health-insurance cost information, childcare invoices, and proof of other support obligations.
- A neutral calendar of actual parenting time, exchanges, school events, appointments, and missed or changed periods.
- Relevant communications in complete context. Preserve originals and avoid editing screenshots.

Questions to verify

- Which official New Hampshire form and filing path apply to this case?
- Is service required, and who may complete it?
- Are mediation, financial affidavits, or updated child-support worksheets required?
- Does the present order remain fully enforceable while a modification request is pending?

Source check

Use official New Hampshire Judicial Branch, New Hampshire General Court, or responsible agency materials for current law and procedure.